

Abdullah Al Zahid

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Talent Acquisition

Operations

Metrolinx, 130 Adelaide Street West

Re: Rail Simulation Specialist (Job ID 117317)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to be considered for the Rail Simulation Specialist position. I spent 2023 in the Metrolinx Service Design office as a Transportation Planner in simulation and modelling, and rail network simulation in OpenTrack was the substance of that year, so the posting reads closely to work I already know.

The role is described as modelling and simulating rail network utilization scenarios, conducting network analyses and studies, and validating service level increases using OpenTrack. That was the shape of my work at Metrolinx. I built and tested network scenarios against infrastructure constraints, speed restrictions and corridor conditions, and much of my time went into establishing what a proposed operating or infrastructure change would do to run times, schedule reliability and recovery before it was taken forward. Looking at run-time patterns across subdivisions to see where schedules were likely to come under pressure was part of that.

One line in the posting I would pick out is construction activity that reduces capacity, and recommending solutions for high-risk areas. A good deal of my Metrolinx work sat there: assessing what temporary and permanent slow orders would do to run times, connections and recovery, and how far the effect carried beyond the subdivision it sat on. Before that I spent a short placement with Mott MacDonald on Ontario Line work, simulating how construction staging would affect the surrounding network, which is the same question asked from the road side.

Since January 2024 I have been an Assistant Planner with the City of Toronto. I analyse network capacity, review development applications and engineering studies for their effect on planned infrastructure, and write the technical reports and briefing notes that carry findings to colleagues in other divisions. Working with municipalities, consultants and agencies whose priorities do not line up is routine there rather than exceptional.

Two things I should be straightforward about. My direct rail simulation experience is one year, and it is commuter rail rather than the wider mix of passenger and freight networks the posting asks for. And while I am comfortable in OpenTrack, I have not used Rail Traffic Controller, and my knowledge of the applicable standards and regulations is general rather than detailed.

Thank you for taking the time to consider my application. I would welcome the chance to discuss the role.

Sincerely,

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